

RICARDO MANUEL ESPAÑOL ROWE

AI Operations Specialist

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Available immediately | Open to hybrid and remote work | [ricardoespanolrowe.com](https://www.ricardoespanolrowe.com)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I help operations and customer support teams eliminate manual work with AI tools in production. I bring **more than 24 years** of experience in operations, customer and student support, and B2B business development. Since 2025 I have designed and taken to production **two internal AI tools** built with Claude Code, used by the support and the withdrawals & refunds teams, with measurable results in resolution times and AI-resolved conversations.

CAREER OBJECTIVE

My goal is an AI Operations or business process automation role (operations, back-office, customer support), turning manual processes into AI-powered tools the business uses every day.

CORE SKILLS

- **Applied AI:** conversational AI assistants, prompt engineering, Claude Code (CLI), LLM APIs (Grok, OpenAI), Google AI Studio.
- **Automation & processes:** identifying automation opportunities, end-to-end design of internal tools, Intercom workflows (automated conversation routing), PostgreSQL / Data Warehouse, role-based access control, reporting and KPIs (Looker Studio).
- **Adoption & responsible AI:** user training and support, pilot and phased rollout, human validation for sensitive decisions, and handoff to a person when the AI should not answer.
- **Operations & customer/student support:** student lifecycle management, complex issue resolution, support workflow optimization.
- **Business management:** B2B sales, key account negotiation, portfolio retention and loyalty, Salesforce as a user (with some configuration).
- **Languages:** Bilingual English–Spanish.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

thePower | *Student Success & Operations*

April 2020 – September 2026

- Operational leadership in Student Success and support, coordinating a team of 6 people without a formal title: student lifecycle management, technical issue resolution and optimization of mass-communication workflows.
- Designed and built from scratch (Claude Code) a web application to manage student withdrawals and refunds, integrated with PostgreSQL (institutional Data Warehouse) and role-based access control across 4 roles. It automates request validation and data cross-checking for refunds, leaving final execution to human judgment given the sensitive amounts involved. Result: **100% of requests resolved within 3 days** (down from 2 weeks to 1 month) and a **60% reduction in the number of refunds processed**: by speeding up the flow of information and involving the right people from the start, students are contacted in time and refunds caused by missed deadlines or handling errors are avoided. Includes a KPI module for managers. In production for more than a year as the school-wide standard tool for the withdrawals and refunds process, used by the 15 people who handle these requests.
- Designed and built from scratch (Claude Code) PowerCom, an AI-powered student-support assistant (Grok API) to replace Intercom, integrated with the Data Warehouse to personalize answers based on each student's program. Handles **~2,000 tickets/month** and escalates to a human agent only for out-of-scope queries or signs of frustration. The AI answers **55% of conversations** (vs. 15% with Intercom) and resolves 85% of them; used by 25 people across the support team and managers. In production since December 2025; Intercom remains as a backup until its contract ends (December 2026) while users migrate gradually. With no per-user cost, it is available to everyone on the team who needs it and will allow Intercom to be dropped from 2027: projected savings of ~€42,000/year across the annual contract and per-user licenses.
- For both tools, end-to-end project ownership: identifying the need and pitching it to management, defining requirements and workflows with the team, data and role-based permissions design, prompt design (PowerCom), testing, deployment, user training and adoption, and KPI tracking for continuous improvement. PostgreSQL integration in collaboration with the IT team.

- Analysis of support metrics in Intercom (response times, NPS and quality) to identify bottlenecks and propose product improvements and workflow automation. Built refund and sales reports in Looker Studio for a year, until the refunds reporting moved to the KPI module of the refunds tool.
- Configured Intercom workflows to automatically route incoming conversations by team and student program.

Genera Asesores Tributarios

External Advisor (occasional, alongside thePower)

May 2020 – December 2025

- Occasional advisory work on operations and, more recently, on process automation, alongside the main role at thePower.

Sales Manager

January 2019 – May 2020

- Managed key accounts and optimized customer service operations, ensuring the scalability of internal advisory processes.
- Ongoing analysis of sales and operational KPIs to redesign department workflows and speed up response times.

Ayming | *Senior Account Manager & Business Development*

2007 – 2018

- Prospecting and management of large B2B accounts in value-added consulting, negotiation of complex commercial proposals, coordination of projects between the client and internal technical teams, and portfolio retention, consistently meeting annual revenue targets.

Alico AIG Life | *Insurance Agent; Team Leader from 2004*

2002 – 2007

- Started as an Insurance Agent and took on the leadership of a 5-person sales team in 2004, combining both roles until 2007: training, mentoring, market prospecting and target management by geographic area.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- Bachelor's Degree in Business Administration and Management (LADE).
- Master's in Digital Marketing – thePower.
- Designing and implementing a conversational framework for support teams – thePower.
- Fundamentals for support managers – thePower.
- Digital Transformation Certification – thePower.
- Integrated Bilingual Education – British Council School.
- [In progress] AI Maker & Automation Master's – thePower Tech School. Expected completion: December 2026.